

Reading Nutri-Grade Labels

Nutri-Grade helps you compare drinks quickly when you are choosing what to buy or order. It is most useful when you use it together with your usual drink habits.

What the grades mean

Beverages are graded A to D based on sugar and saturated fat. In general, A and B choices are lower in these nutrients, while C and D choices are higher. The grade does not turn a drink into a full meal or a health treatment; it simply gives a quick signal about the drink.

Grade	What it usually signals	How to use it
A	Lowest range among graded drinks	Choose often
B	Lower range	Good everyday option
C	Higher range	Choose less often
D	Highest range	Keep occasional

Water does not need a grade to be a good default. Unsweetened tea or coffee can also be everyday choices if they suit you.

How to choose at shops

When comparing packaged drinks, look at the Nutri-Grade mark first, then the serving size. A smaller pack can still contain a lot of sugar if it is very sweet. If you drink sweet beverages daily, move one step at a time: from D to C, from C to B, or from sweetened to unsweetened.

Do not rely only on words like "natural" or "premium". Compare the grade and the nutrition panel. Fruit drinks, milk teas, and flavoured coffees can vary widely.

Kopi and teh ordering tips

At the coffee shop, the words you use matter. "Kosong" means no added sugar. "Siew dai" means less sweet. If you usually take a sweet drink, try siew dai first, then work towards kosong if you can enjoy it. For iced drinks, remember that syrup and sweetened creamer can add up quickly.

Usual order	Gentler next step	Further step
Kopi or teh sweet	Kopi siew dai or teh siew dai	Kopi kosong or teh kosong
Sweet iced drink	Less syrup	Plain water or unsweetened tea
Bubble tea	Lower sweetness and fewer toppings	Keep for occasional treats

Build a new habit

Pick one drink slot to change first, such as the afternoon drink or the drink that comes with lunch. Keep your favourite sweet drink for selected days instead of every day. If you are thirsty, drink water first, then decide whether you still want the sweet drink.

Key points

- Nutri-Grade grades A-D are based on sugar and saturated fat.
- Choose A or B drinks more often, and C or D drinks less often.
- Use "kosong" and "siew dai" to reduce sweetness in kopi and teh.
- Check serving size as well as the grade.
- Change one regular drink habit at a time.

When to talk to a health professional

Speak to a doctor or dietitian if you have diabetes, kidney disease, swallowing problems, or another condition where drink choices have been personalised for you.

This guide is sample content written for the LiveWell Coach workshop. It is general information, not medical advice. If you have symptoms or a health condition, speak to a doctor.